themselves. It still felt so recently that I'd tried to smoke at 15 and thrown up and had to be picked up by my dad. That and Gary Keedy's smoke alarm was enough to put me off the whole thing.

I am still living at home, bouncing back and forth from this new abnormal and what I have always known. To get to practice, my mum and dad drive me to the McDonald's 20 minutes outside of Burnley, in Haslingden. Stranded between stations, I wait, struck by how much McDonald's and cigarettes there are in a professional cricketer's life, before Graham Lloyd picks me up. When Graham can't, Joe Scuderi does. He gets me to meet him at his house, where he has a shrine to Kiss, and we listen to AC/DC and hair metal all the way into Old Trafford.

For some reason, I start to go to Glam and Go Tanning Salon in Burnley, turning back up to Lancashire County games bronzed and with bleached highlights in my hair. *I'm going to have to bowl well now*, I think to myself. You can't go to Glam and Go, be singing guitar riffs you've just learnt under your breath, turn up at Lancashire all bronzed when everyone knows you haven't been on holiday and then serve up wides. Ever since Mark Harvey had driven back to Burnley, his Lancashire deal just signed and a Peugeot 206 with his name on the side, that's all I'd wanted. I got mine too.